# Grief and Loss

How do we love what we know we will lose?

**READING · TWO SHORT CHAPTERS**

**Epictetus, *Enchiridion* 3 and 11.** Remember that what you love is mortal. And of anything you lose, never say “I have lost it,” but “I have restored it.”

**BEFORE THE MEETING**

Grief can be raw. In the announcement, say the topic plainly, and at the meeting let anyone pass on personal examples.

| Open · 10 | Read · 10 | Discuss · 45 | Practice · 15 | Close · 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ground rules; anyone may pass | Aloud, together | The questions below | Returned, not lost | One takeaway each |

## DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Epictetus says to remember that what we love is mortal. Is that comforting or cold?
2. What’s the difference between “I lost it” and “I restored it”?
3. Can a Stoic grieve? What would healthy Stoic grief look like?
4. How can we value someone fully while accepting they’re on loan?
5. If you’re willing to share: what helped you most in a past loss?

**PRACTICE THIS MONTH**

**Returned, not lost.** When you lose something small this month, a pen or an opportunity, practice saying “it was returned.”

**FACILITATOR’S MOVE**

**“Is that always true?”** Gently test absolute claims, like “you never get over it.”

## NOTES